

fixed capital formation in India as percentage of GDP is at 34 per cent, highest since 2013-14. Credit growth in 2022-23 surged to almost 15 per cent, the strongest in almost a decade. These indicators point to the beginning of a new private capex cycle.

Domestic consumption, both rural and urban, remains strong. Inflation is on a downward path, forex flows have been strong in the current year. With every indicator looking up, growth is bound to be strong. In the last nine years, FDI inflows have doubled, forex reserves have doubled, central government capex has increased more than five times, bank balance sheets have been repaired and they are profit making.

I am quite positive that India's economy will continue performing well and deliver unprecedented opportunities and prosperity for our people.

Q: With companies like Apple and Tesla showing interest in developing manufacturing centres in India, to what extent in your view has the country made progress in turning into a viable alternative global production hub to China? How do you assess the execution of the Make in India programme and what more do you think needs to be done for India to benefit from the China+1 pivot in global supply chains?

A: I am surprised by your question. If someone is exercising to improve his own health, should it be seen as his preparation to fight someone else?

We have one of the youngest and most talented youth in the world. Should they not have the freedom to dream of progress? If India has such a big market, should it not dream of also becoming a manufacturing power? I want my fellow citizens to have access to facilities as good as those of developed countries. The world is today recognising India's strength. They are coming here because it is good for their company, their product and their profits.

The efforts we are making since 2014 should have been made 40-45 years ago. At that time, the country knew which were the right things to do, but the decision makers took the wrong decisions.

We have been focussing on increasing manufacturing and improving ease of doing business since 2014. Through focus on world class infrastructure, skill development of our workforce, supportive policies and attractive fiscal incentives, we are transforming our manufacturing sector.

The growth of Apple's manufacturing footprint in India, the decision of Micron to set up semiconductor assembly in India, all show the increasing attractiveness of India as a manufacturing destination.

Building up scale and volume is critical to being able to turn India to a competitive alternative global production hub. That is where attracting investments and creation of manufacturing capacities is essential for the development of the supply chain. Our PLI schemes are designed to incentivise companies to increase their manufacturing capacities and local value addition year on year.

Q: Geopolitical headwinds, particularly the Russia-Ukraine war make the task of forging global consensus complicated. During India's presidency how do you hope to deal with issues on which finding global consensus has proven difficult? We are seeing different countries try to find a way of forging peace between

“Building on our success and recognising the importance of start-ups globally, India, during its G20 leadership, made a significant move by establishing the Startup20 Engagement Group. This is the first of its kind initiative under the G20”

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Russia and Ukraine. As G20 President, do you have a plan which you think may help in finding a way out of the Russia-Ukraine war?

A: As per your business strategy, you are coming out with a special issue on G20. However, your question is more about a political debate. Therefore, you should assess whether it is desirable to link G20 or our G20 presidency with this issue.

I would like to ask you—why did it occur to you to ask about just this issue as if there is only one problem in the world? Why did it not occur to you that there are problems in other parts of the world like in Syria, in some countries in Africa, in East Asia, in Latin America? As a business magazine, why didn't it occur to you to focus on the meetings of G20 held so far rather than focussing on political debates?